Lesson 1: Templates That Write Themselves

Module 1 | 60 minutes | Templates and merge | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise what you learned today. Read each task carefully.

1. Key words

Match each word to what it means. Write the letter.

a. template ___ A. Joining one template with a list so each person gets their own personal message.
b. placeholder ___ B. A blank like {{First Name}} that mail merge fills from a column in your sheet.
c. merge field ___ C. A blank like [Customer name] that marks what changes each time.
d. mail merge ___ D. A message or prompt you write once and reuse, changing only the blanks.

2. Prompt Lab: a reusable prompt template

Kabir runs a courier booking counter. Every Monday he messages business customers about pickups booked for that week. Write a reusable prompt template that asks the AI to draft this message. Use [placeholders] for the details that change, say who it is for, the tone and length, tell the AI not to add facts, and tell it to keep the placeholders unchanged. Write your prompt here, then try it in ChatGPT or Claude or Gemini or Microsoft Copilot.

3. Prompt Lab: a mail-merge formula

You have fee_reminders_practice.csv open (A First Name, B Batch, C Amount Due, D Due Date). Write a prompt asking the AI for ONE formula that builds a personal reminder in column F for each row. Name your app, describe the columns, give an example of the finished sentence, ask for the amount and date to be formatted, ask how to fill it down, and ask for a simple explanation. Write your prompt here, then try it in ChatGPT or Claude or Gemini or Microsoft Copilot.

4. Match each part of a good template to the job it does

Draw a line from each word to its match.

a. [Placeholders] like [Due date] ..... A. Helps a colleague pick the right template fast
b. “Do not add any facts” ..... B. Keeps a WhatsApp message easy to read
c. “Keep the merge fields exactly as written” ..... C. Stops a renamed field from leaving a blank
d. “Under 50 words” ..... D. Stops the AI inventing fees, dates or promises
e. A “when to use” note in the library ..... E. Mark exactly what changes each time

5. Make a template, or write it fresh each time?

Write each item in the right group: Make a template (it repeats) / Write it fresh (one-off or sensitive).

a. Weekly pickup reminder to business customers → _____
b. Monthly fee reminder to parents → _____
c. Condolence message to a colleague who lost a parent → _____
d. Diwali greeting to all customers → _____
e. Monday review meeting invite → _____
f. Apology to one client for a serious billing mistake → _____
g. Welcome email for every new joiner → _____
h. Reply to a legal notice → _____

How did it go? Colour a face: 😀 I can do it · 🙂 Nearly there · 🤔 I need help

☐ I can turn a repeated message into a prompt template with placeholders.

☐ I can get a mail-merge style formula from AI and build personal messages in a sheet.

☐ I can preview merged messages and catch a renamed or empty field.

☐ I can start a template library with notes on when to use each template.